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June 28, 1974
SUPERSEDING
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August 9, 1968

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BAG, SOILED CLOTHES, NYLON

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for rope-closing and self-closing ropeless nylon laundry bags.

1.2 Classification. The laundry bags covered by this specification shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Ropeless, self-closing
Size 18 - 18 inch diameter
Size 25 - 25 inch diameter

Type II - Rope-closing
Size 25 - 25 inch diameter

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of solicitation for offers or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

V-T-295 - Thread, Nylon.
CCC-T-191 - Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 595 - Colors.
Fed. Std. No. 751 - Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Office in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications: The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addresses to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Basic cloth. The basic cloth shall be a combination filament and spun nylon fabric weighing not less than 5.4 ounces per square yard when tested as specified in 4.4. The cloth shall be plain weave, and shall have 68 yarns per inch minimum in the warp direction, and 42 yarns per inch minimum in the filling direction, when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.1.1.1 Shrinkage. The finished cloth shall not shrink more than 12 per cent in the warp direction or 5 per cent in the filling direction, when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.1.1.2 Breaking strength. The minimum breaking strength, after shrinkage, shall be 315 pounds in the warp and 300 pounds in the filling when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.1.1.3 Color. Unless otherwise specified, the basic cloth shall be the undyed natural white color of the nylon.

3.1.1.4 Identification (color stripe). The cloth used for the identification stripe shall be cotton or nylon having a minimum weight of 3 ounces per square yard when tested as specified in 4.4. The color shall be yellow and shall approximately match color number 33538 of Fed. Std. No. 595. The laundered cloth shall show no perceptible color change from the unlaundered cloth when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.1.2 Thread. Sewing thread used throughout shall be nylon or ployester respectively of type I, class 2, letter size E, natural color of V-T-295 or type I, class 1, size E, natural color of V-T-295.

3.1.3 Grommet. The grommet used on the type II rope-closing bag shall be a #3, plain brass, toothed washer type.

3.1.4 Rope. The rope used for the drawstring closure on the type II bag shall be #6 solid braid nylon, pre-shrunk, natural white color.

3.2 Stitches, seams and stitching. All stitch, seam and stitching types specified are those covered in Fed. Std. No. 751. All seaming and stitching, except overedge stitching, shall be done with stitch type 301 or 401 and there shall be at least six stitches, but not more than eight stitches per inch. Stitch type 502 or 503 shall be used where overedge stitching is specified. Thread breaks and ends of all seams and stitching shall be backstitched not less than 1/2 inch when not caught in other seams or stitching. Thread tension shall be maintained properly so that there will be no loose stitching.

3.3 Design and construction.

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3.3.1 Type I, ropeless, self-closing. The self-closing ropeless bag shall be designed to form a body with a square bottom with rounded corners and an envelope-type cap cover which shall be capable of being turned over the top of the bag to form a complete closure to prevent contents from spilling or being exposed when bag is inverted (see figures 1 and 2). The bag shall be equipped with two built-in handles or a functional equivalent on the bottom part for handling when bag is closed. Two loops at the top, in the inside of the fold-over flap, shall provide hand grips to facilitate reversing the flap to close the bag. They shall be positioned so that by putting both hands under the flaps and grasping each loop, a pulling motion outward and upward will reverse position of flap thereby closing the open top of bag.

3.3.1.1 Construction. The bag shall be constructed of two pieces of cloth (3.1.1) of equal widths but of unequal lengths. The longer piece of cloth shall be folded over towards the outside of the bag to form a flap. The end of the flap and the plain side of the top of the bag shall be hemmed using stitching type EFb-2. The hems shall be turned to the outside of the bag and shall finish to a minimum width of 1-3/8 inches. The top of the flap side of the bag shall contain two rows of stitching 1/4 inch and 1 inch respectively from folded edge. The side edges shall be securely stitched together, including the flap, employing seam type SSa-1 and overedged. Stitching shall be 7/16 ± 1/8 inch from edge of material. The bottom shall be formed by inserting a piece of cloth and securely stitching it to the bottom edges, using same seam types and overedging used on side seams. The finished dimensions shall be as specified in table I (3.3.1.2).

3.3.1.1.1 Loops (hand grips). Two loops fabricated from nylon webbing or tape of a quality and grade best suited for the purpose shall be securely stitched inside the flap to provide hand grips to facilitate closing the bag. The finished loops shall be 3 ± 1/4 inches in length and 3/4 inch in width. A loop shall be located 3 ± 1/4 inches from each inside corner.

3.3.1.1.2 Handles. Two pocket type handles or a functional equivalent shall be provided near the bottom of the bag to facilitate lifting and handling when the bag is closed. The handles, located one on each side of the bag, shall not become detached from body when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.3.1.1.3 Reinforcement. Strain areas shall be suitably reinforced. The corners formed where bottom of flap joins the body of the bag shall be reinforced with a gusset or equitable type of reinforcement.

3.3.1.2 Dimensions. The finished bag shall meet the dimensions specified in table I.

TABLE I. Type I, finished dimensions 1/

Commercial Size Designation	Width 2/	Length 3/	Bottom Square Dimensions	Length of flap
18-inch	30	46	13-1/2	16
25-inch	39-1/2	46	17-1/2	18

1/ All measurements are in inches and a plus or minus tolerance of 1 inch will be permitted.
2/ Measured across top of bag 1/2 to 1 inch below hem from side seam to side seam with bag folded flat in open position.
3/ Measured from top edge of bag to bottom seam with bag folded flat in open position.

3.3.1.3 Color stripe identification. When specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.2), a verticle stripe of yellow cloth (see 3.1.1.4) shall be securely stitched to center of bag employing stitching type EFa-1 with a 1/4 inch minimum turnunder and 1/8 inch stitching margins from folded edges. A single row of stitching down center of stripe shall further secure stripe to the bag. The stripe shall run from top to bottom in both sides of bag and across diameter of bottom of bag. A corresponding stripe shall be stitched on outside of cap cover so that when in a closed position, the bag shall be completely encircled by a yellow stripe. The finished stripe shall be a minimum of 2-1/4 inches wide.

3.3.2 Type II, rope-closing. The type II bag shall be designed to form a round body with a rectangular bottom with rounded corners, and a drawstring type of closure (see figure 3).

3.3.2.1 Construction. The body of the bag shall be constructed from one piece of cloth (3.1.1). The verticle seam joining the ends shall be seam type LSc-2. Stitching gage shall be 1/4 inch and stitching margins shall be 1/16 inch. A tunnel shall be formed at the top of the bag making a 2-1/2 ± 1/4 inches wide hem, employing stitching type EFb-1 with a 1/2 inch minimum turnunder. The bottom shall be joined to the body by the seam type LSq-2, or SSa-1 and overedge. One #3 brass grommet shall be inserted in the center of the hem which forms the tunnel at the top of bag. The grommet shall be

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reinforced with an additional piece of cloth of the same material as the body not less than 1-1/4 inches wide and of sufficient length to be folded into four thicknesses of material not less than 2 inches long. The grommet shall be tightly clinched into the hem and the reinforcement on the inside of hem to provide the opening to the tunnel.

3.3.2.1.1 Drawstring. A drawstring made of nylon rope (3.1.4) not less than 8 feet long shall be inserted into the tunnel so that the two ends protrude through the grommet. The rope shall have non-raveling ends which shall be fastened together by means of a clip fabricated from corrosion resistant steel. Each bag shall be equipped with a rope-holding closure device of plastic or corrosion resistant metal. The closure device shall have a self-locking feature which will hold it in a locked position until manually released. The rope-holding closure device shall not corrode, deform, or become inoperable when subjected to the laundering test in 4.4. The rope-holding closure device shall not deform, become inoperable, or perceptibly move except when released, when tested as specified in 4.4.2.

3.3.2.1.2 Dimensions. The finished dimensions of the type II bag shall conform to the minimum requirements specified in table II.

TABLE II. Type II, finished dimensions 1/

Commercial Size Designation	Width 2/	Length 2/	Bottom Rectangular dimensions
25-inch	39-1/2	37	22 by 24

1/ All measurements are in inches and a plus or minus tolerance of 1 inch will be permitted.
2/ Measured with bag folded flat in open position. Length measured from top edge of bag to bottom of seam.

3.4 Identification marking. Each bag shall contain a label legibly and permanently marked in black with the contractors name or trade name and size of bag. The label shall be of the type used in standard commercial practice and shall be securely attached to the hem at top of the bag.

3.5 Workmanship. The workmanship shall be first class throughout. Completed bags shall be well made, clean, free from loose threads and defects that may affect appearance, serviceability, or durability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may use his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications, unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.1 Sampling and inspection for lot acceptance. Sampling and inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein. For sampling purposes, a lot shall consist of all items of the same type and size submitted for delivery at one time.

4.2.2 Sampling for testing. The sample unit for testing of each component not covered by subsidiary specifications referenced herein shall be the amount of material required to perform all required determinations for all test characteristics once. Unless otherwise specified in subsidiary specifications, the inspection level for each component shall be S-1 of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level (AQL) for each characteristic tested shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units. The lot size and sample unit for testing shall be as follows:

Component	Lot size expressed as:	Sample unit for testing
Basic cloth	Yard	3 yards, full width
Color cloth	Yard	1 yard, full width

4.3 Visual examination. Defects found during this examination shall be classified in accordance with defects listed in table III. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated bag. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 2.5 major and 4.0 minor defects per hundred units.

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TABLE III. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Material			
Type I and II	Basic cloth not natural white undyed nylon as specified.	X	
	Thread not nylon of type, class, and size specified.		X
Type II only	Drawstring not nylon rope as specified.	X	
	Grommet not size or metal specified.		X
	Grommet not of type specified.	X	
Construction, Workmanship, and Appearance			
Type I and II	Any spot or stain clearly noticeable.	X	
	Any hole, cut, tear, or other fabric defect affecting appearance and serviceability.	X	
	Mends, darns, and patches.	X	
	Stitching not type specified for applicable seam or attachment.	X	
	Any required row of stitches omitted.	X	
	Thread tension not uniform; evidence of area of loose stitching.	X	
	Thread breaks, skipped or broken stitches not overstitched.	X	
	Any raw edge caused by omission of over-edge stitching	X	
	Seam twisted, puckered, or pleated, affecting appearance.		X
	Label omitted; incorrect; illegible or misplaced.		X
Type I only	Bottom flap corners not reinforced.	X	
	Hand grips (loops) missing or misplaced.	X	
	One or both handles missing.	X	
	Overall dimensions not as specified.	X	
	Color stripe, when specified, not securely attached.	X	
Type II only	Dimensions not as specified.	X	
	Drawstring ends not fastened together.	X	
	Drawstring holding device missing.	X	
	Drawstring less than 8 feet long.	X	
	Grommet improperly located.		X
	Grommet not securely clinched and reinforced.	X	

4.3.1 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping or distortion of container.

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4.4 Tests. The methods of testing as specified in CCC-T-191, wherever applicable, and as listed in table V shall be followed. Unless otherwise specified, all testing requirements apply to the sample unit.

TABLE V. Test Methods

Component	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	Results reported as:
Basic cloth	Weight	3.1.1	5041	Average of 5 determinations to nearest 0.1 oz.
	Yarns per inch	3.1.1	5050	Pass or fail.
	Shrinkage in laundering	3.1.1.1	5552	Nearest 0.1 percent.
	Breaking strength	3.1.1.2	5100	Average of 5 determinations to nearest 0.1 oz.
Color stripe cloth	Weight	3.1.1.4	5041	Average of 5 determinations to nearest 0.1 oz.
	Color	3.1.1.4	Visual	Pass or fail.
	Colorfastness to laundering	3.1.1.4	5610	Pass or fail.
Handles (type I)	Shall not become detached from body of bag	3.3.1.1.2	Par. 4.4.1	Pass or fail.
Rope holding closure device (type II)	Shall not corrode, deform, and become inoperable, or perceptibly move when in locked position	3.3.2.1.1	5610 and Par. 4.4.2 as applicable	Pass or fail.

4.4.1 Handle durability (type I only). A completely fabricated bag shall be used for purposes of this test. The body of the bag shall be held with a suitable holding device. The handle shall be grasped with another holding device and, with a spring scale or weight, a pulling force of 50 pounds shall be applied in a direction to pull handle from body to determine compliance with 3.3.1.1.2. Each handle shall be tested separately.

4.4.2 Performance of rope-holding closure device (type II). In a manner consistent with normal use, slide the closure device back and forth the full length of the exposed rope 50 times in each direction. After the last slide, position the closure device so that the bag is closed and the device locked in place. Holding the bag with one hand, grasp the closure device with the other hand and exert a pulling force of 20 ± 1 pounds. Examine for compliance with 3.3.2.1.1.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Levels A and B. Eighteen bags shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. Bags shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rates, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The laundry bags covered by this specification are intended for use in the collection and transportation of soiled linen and clothing in patient areas of hospitals.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Types and sizes required (see 1.2).
(c) Whether a yellow color stripe is required (see 3.3.1.3).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Illustrations. The illustrations shown herein as figures 1, 2, and 3 are for purposes of illustrating the general design and are not intended to preclude any soiled clothes bag which otherwise meets the requirements of this specification.

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

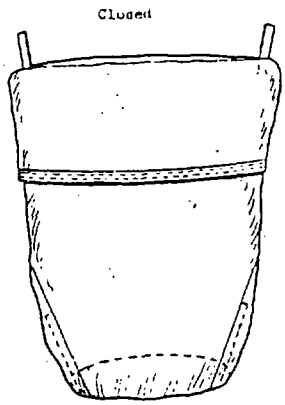


Figure 1.

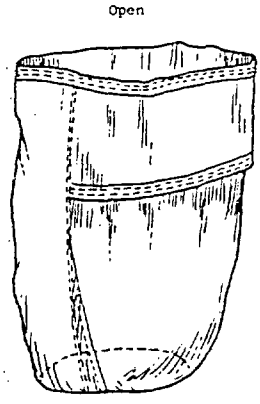


Figure 2.

Type I. Ropeless, self-closing bag.

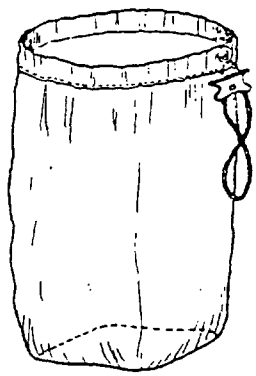


Figure 3.

Type II. Rope-closing bag

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 25 cents each.

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